ISACA Chapter Leader Guidebook

Chapter President

Last Updated August 2026

What do I need to know as a chapter president?

Table of Contents

Welcome! **2**

Roles and Responsibilities of the Chapter President **2**

Regional Strategic Advisory Council 2

Governance 2

General Leadership 3

Finances 3

Reporting 4

Meetings **4**

Chapter Board Meetings 4

Regular or Special Membership Meetings 4

Immediately Following the Annual General Meeting (AGM) 4

Chapter Leader Listing on Hosted Chapter Websites 5

Mentoring **5**

Succession Planning **5**

Turnover Procedures **6**

Appendix **6**

Timetable for Action/President's Annual Checklist 6

Key Links **7**

All questions, concerns, comments, reports, and notifications should be submitted to ISACA Support using the "Chapter" tab.

Welcome!

Congratulations, and welcome to your role as the chapter president of your ISACA chapter!

The chapter president serves as the chief elected officer of the chapter and the primary local representative of ISACA. As the leader of the chapter's board and volunteer organization, the president provides strategic direction, fosters effective governance, and supports the achievement of the chapter's mission and objectives.

Working collaboratively with the board, volunteers, and staff (where applicable), the President helps ensure that chapter's programs, services, and operations deliver value to members, promote professional growth and engagement and contribute to the chapter's long-term sustainability and success.

The Chapter President is responsible for implementing the policies and decisions of the chapter board by:

- Ensuring the chapter operates in accordance with its bylaws, board-approved policies, and applicable ISACA Global requirements, and
- Exercising appropriate leadership and judgment to address operational matters when specific policies or procedures have not been established, while remaining accountable to the chapter board.

Additionally, the Chapter President should:

- Lead the chapter's annual strategic planning process, working with the chapter board to establish goals and objectives that support member value, chapter sustainability, and alignment with ISACA's global mission and strategic priorities.
- Monitor chapter performance and compliance with applicable ISACA Global and chapter requirements. If the chapter experiences challenges meeting established standards, the President should promptly engage the Chapter Experience team through ISACA Support for guidance and assistance.
- Provide leadership and oversight to the chapter board and volunteer leadership structure, ensuring effective coordination among officers, directors, committee chairs, and other volunteers in support of the chapter's strategic goals.

Foster collaboration, accountability, and succession planning within the chapter's leadership team to promote continuity and long-term success.

Roles and Responsibilities of the Chapter President

Regional Strategic Advisory Council

All chapter presidents are ex-officio members of ISACA's Regional Strategic Advisory Council (SAC). The SAC provides a forum for chapter leaders to share insights, identify regional needs and opportunities, and inform the development of initiatives that support members, chapters, and the profession. Participation in the SAC helps ensure that chapter perspectives are represented in regional discussions and strategic

planning efforts.

Chapter Presidents will receive an invitation when meetings for their respective Regional SAC are scheduled and are encouraged to actively participate in these discussions.

Governance

As an independent legal entity, the chapter is solely responsible for its own legal, financial, and operational affairs. As Chapter President, you play a key role in helping ensure the chapter operates in accordance with applicable laws and regulations, the ISACA Chapter Affiliation Agreement, chapter bylaws and other ISACA Global policies and requirements.

To support effective governance, the Chapter President should:

- Promote compliance with applicable laws, regulations, chapter governing documents, and ISACA requirements.
- Help safeguard member and chapter data by supporting compliance with data privacy and security requirements, including applicable local regulations (such as GDPR) and ISACA policies.
-
- Lead the development and periodic review of the chapter's strategic plan in collaboration with the board, and monitor progress toward established goals and objectives.
- Implement the policies and decisions of the chapter board and support accountability for their execution.
- Exercise appropriate executive leadership and judgment on operational matters when specific policies or procedures do not exist, while remaining accountable to the chapter board.
- Recommend the establishment of committees and, with board approval and in accordance with the chapter bylaws, appoint committee chairs and other volunteer leaders as needed.
- Serve as an ex officio member of all committees, except the Nominating Committee, unless otherwise provided in the chapter bylaws.
- Oversee the nomination and election processes to help ensure compliance with the chapter bylaws and applicable governance requirements.
- Work with the board and volunteer leaders to identify risks to achieving strategic objectives and implement appropriate corrective actions when necessary.
- Ensure the chapter offers a sustainable portfolio of programs, events, and services that provide value to members and support member engagement, professional development, and chapter growth.

General Leadership

While the Chapter President provides leadership and oversight, responsibility for governance and strategic direction rests with the chapter board collectively. The President should work collaboratively with the board, committees, volunteers, and staff to advance the chapter's mission and long-term sustainability.

The Chapter President should:

- Provide leadership in developing and maintaining an effective chapter governance structure, including board and committee roles, responsibilities, and reporting relationships, in accordance with the chapter bylaws.
- Foster clear communication, accountability, and collaboration among board members, committee leaders, and volunteers.
- Inspire, support, recognize, and encourage board members, committee leaders, and volunteers to advance the chapter's mission and strategic objectives.
- Promote a culture of teamwork, inclusion, professionalism, and volunteer engagement throughout the chapter.
- Mentor and support officers, directors, committee chairs, and emerging leaders to strengthen leadership development and succession planning.
- Lead and facilitate the chapter's annual strategic planning process, working with the board to establish goals, objectives, priorities, and measures of success.
- Work with the board and volunteer leaders to establish an annual operating calendar that supports timely execution of key chapter activities, governance requirements, and strategic initiatives.
- Oversee periodic reviews of the chapter bylaws and governing documents and recommend updates, as appropriate, to ensure continued relevance and compliance.
- Provide oversight of chapter programs, events, communications, and marketing activities to help ensure alignment with the chapter's strategic goals, brand standards, and member needs.
- Provide oversight of the chapter's digital presence, including the chapter website and social media channels, to help ensure content is accurate, current, and consistent with ISACA and chapter policies.
- Supervise and support chapter staff, if any, in accordance with applicable employment policies and board direction.
- Lead succession planning efforts for chapter leadership positions by identifying, developing, and encouraging future leaders and volunteers in collaboration with the board and committee leaders.
- Serve as the chapter's primary ambassador and relationship builder, fostering collaboration with other professional organizations, community stakeholders, ISACA chapters, and regional leaders where appropriate.
- Support membership growth, retention, and engagement efforts by working with the Membership Director and other volunteers to develop and implement initiatives that deliver value to members and recognize member contributions and achievements.

Finances

The Chapter President shares responsibility with the chapter board for fiduciary oversight of the chapter and should work closely with the Chapter Treasurer to promote sound financial management, transparency, and compliance. While the Treasurer typically oversees the day-to-day administration of financial activities, the President helps ensure appropriate financial controls, reporting, and governance practices are in place.

The Chapter President should:

- Work with the Chapter Treasurer and board to help ensure compliance with applicable financial, labor, tax, and regulatory requirements.
- Promote effective risk management and strong internal controls over chapter finances.
    - It is **strongly recommended** that chapters require dual authorization or multiple signatures for disbursements exceeding a board-established threshold and periodically review authorized signatories on all financial accounts.
    - It is **strongly recommended** that the Chapter President and/or Treasurer regularly consult with the chapter's financial institution and financial advisors, as appropriate, to assess and implement fraud prevention and risk mitigation measures.
- Provide oversight of the chapter's budgeting, financial reporting, and financial management processes to help ensure compliance with chapter policies, applicable requirements, and generally accepted financial management practices.
- Review periodic financial reports and bank reconciliations with the Treasurer and ensure that material discrepancies, unusual transactions, or control concerns are promptly investigated and addressed.
- Help ensure that adequate financial records and supporting documentation are maintained in accordance with the chapter's record retention policies and applicable legal and regulatory requirements.
- Support the implementation and periodic review of a records retention policy. (An example Record Retention Policy is included in the appendix of the Chapter Treasurer Guidebook.)
- Ensure the board receives regular financial reports that accurately present chapter revenues, expenses, assets, liabilities, and budget performance using the chapter's established accounting structure.
- Encourage timely financial reporting and board review. Delays in producing financial information may indicate operational or control issues and can limit the board's ability to monitor financial performance, manage reserves, and take corrective action when necessary.
- Work with the Treasurer and board to address identified financial risks, budget variances, reserve shortfalls, or control deficiencies in a timely manner.

Effective financial stewardship is a shared responsibility of the chapter board. The President should work collaboratively with the Treasurer and other board members to promote accountability, transparency, and the long-term financial sustainability of the chapter.

Reporting

The Chapter President serves as the primary liaison between the chapter and ISACA Global and helps ensure timely, accurate, and transparent reporting to both ISACA and chapter stakeholders.

The Chapter President should:

- Serve as the primary point of contact with ISACA Global for the submission of required chapter information, board rosters, reports, inquiries, and other official communications.
- Work with the chapter board and applicable officers to ensure compliance with all annual reporting requirements and deadlines established by ISACA.
    - This includes ensuring chapter events are entered into the Engage platform, required annual checklists are completed, and audit reports or financial verification letters are submitted within required timeframes following the chapter's Annual General Meeting (AGM).
    - Coordinate the assignment, preparation, review, approval, and submission of required reports and supporting documentation to ISACA Global.
- Establish and support effective reporting processes that provide the board with timely information regarding chapter operations, strategic initiatives, membership trends, program performance, and financial health.
- Ensure the board receives regular reports necessary to fulfill its governance, oversight, and fiduciary responsibilities.
- Promote transparent communication with chapter members by providing regular updates on chapter activities, achievements, strategic priorities, and financial condition, as appropriate.
- Work with chapter officers, committee leaders, and volunteers to ensure reporting is accurate, complete, and submitted in a timely manner.
- Promptly communicate significant chapter issues, risks, compliance concerns, or operational challenges to the chapter board and ISACA Global, as appropriate.

Effective reporting supports transparency, accountability, informed decision-making, and the chapter's ongoing compliance with both ISACA requirements and sound association governance practices.

Meetings

The Chapter President is responsible for providing leadership during board and membership meetings and helping ensure meetings are effective, productive, and aligned with the chapter's strategic objectives. The President should preside over chapter and board meetings whenever possible. If the President is unable to attend, the Vice President or other designated officer should serve in that capacity in accordance with the chapter bylaws.

The Chapter President should:

- Work with the Chapter Secretary and other appropriate officers to develop agendas for board and membership meetings that focus on strategic priorities, governance responsibilities, and key operational matters.
- Collaborate with the Chapter Treasurer to review proposed budgets, financial reports, and significant financial matters before presentation to the board.
- Preside over regular and special meetings of the chapter and its board in accordance with the chapter bylaws and applicable governance requirements.
- Facilitate constructive discussion, encourage participation, and promote informed decision-making by the board.
- Help ensure meeting agendas, materials, and supporting information are distributed in advance to enable effective board deliberation and oversight.
- Maintain order during meetings and help ensure board business is conducted fairly, efficiently, and in accordance with the chapter's governing documents and adopted parliamentary procedures, if applicable.
- Ensure decisions, action items, and follow-up responsibilities are clearly identified and appropriately documented.
- Encourage active engagement by directors, officers, committee chairs, and other participants to support effective governance and leadership.
- Effective meetings enable the board to fulfill its governance responsibilities, make informed decisions, and advance the chapter's mission, strategic goals, and long-term sustainability.

Chapter Board Meetings

As required by the chapter bylaws, the chapter board should meet regularly throughout the year, with a minimum of four board meetings annually. The Chapter President should typically chair these meetings and help ensure they are conducted effectively and in accordance with the chapter's governing documents.

The Chapter President should be responsible for:

- Ensuring board meetings are conducted in compliance with the chapter bylaws, applicable policies, and established governance practices.
- Presiding over board meetings and facilitating productive discussion, informed decision-making, and appropriate board oversight.
- Recognizing, presenting, and ruling on motions in accordance with the chapter's adopted meeting procedures and parliamentary authority, if applicable.
- Helping ensure that all directors have an opportunity to participate in discussions and deliberations.
- Maintaining order and ensuring meetings are conducted efficiently and professionally.
- Confirming that board decisions, motions, and action items are clearly documented by the Secretary.
- Working with the board and Secretary to establish the date, time, and format of future meetings and communicate meeting schedules to board members in a timely manner.
- Monitoring follow-up actions arising from board meetings and supporting accountability for the completion of assigned tasks.
- Effective board meetings are essential to fulfilling the board's governance

responsibilities, overseeing chapter operations, and advancing the chapter's strategic objectives.

Regular or Special Membership Meetings

As required by the chapter bylaws, the chapter should hold membership meetings as specified in its governing documents. The Chapter President should typically preside over these meetings and help ensure they are conducted in a manner that promotes transparency, member engagement, and effective governance.

The Chapter President should:

- Ensure membership meetings are conducted in accordance with the chapter bylaws, applicable policies, and established governance practices.
- Preside over regular, annual, and special membership meetings, as applicable.
- Facilitate orderly and productive discussions while encouraging member participation and engagement.
- Recognize, present, and rule on motions in accordance with the chapter's adopted meeting procedures and parliamentary authority, if applicable.
- Maintain order and ensure business is conducted fairly, professionally, and efficiently.
- Ensure members are provided with appropriate information regarding chapter activities, strategic priorities, governance matters, and financial performance, as appropriate.
- Work with the Chapter Secretary to ensure meeting proceedings, decisions, and actions are accurately documented.
- Coordinate with the board and chapter leadership to schedule and communicate membership meetings in accordance with bylaw requirements and notice provisions.

The Chapter President's responsibilities for membership meetings are generally consistent with those described under **Chapter Board Meetings**, with an additional emphasis on member communication, engagement, and transparency. Membership meetings provide an important opportunity to inform members, gather feedback, and strengthen the connection between the chapter's leadership and its membership.

Immediately Following the Annual General Meeting

Leadership Transition and Reporting

Following the chapter's Annual General Meeting (AGM), or whenever a change in leadership

occurs, the outgoing Chapter President should promptly notify the Chapter Experience team through ISACA Support of all newly elected and appointed chapter leaders. This helps ensure chapter records remain accurate and that new leaders receive timely access to chapter resources, communications, systems, and support.

The outgoing Chapter President should also:

- Ensure that chapter officer and board member information is updated in accordance with ISACA requirements.
- Facilitate a timely and effective leadership transition by transferring relevant records, documentation, credentials, and institutional knowledge to incoming leaders.
- Work with incoming officers to ensure continuity of chapter operations, governance activities, and strategic initiatives.
- Confirm that banking, financial, legal, and administrative records are updated as necessary to reflect leadership changes.
- Support the onboarding of new leaders and encourage their participation in available ISACA training, resources, and leadership development opportunities.

Chapter Leader Listing on Hosted Chapter Websites

Chapter site administrators are responsible for managing the content displayed on the chapter's **About Us** page within chapter websites hosted on ISACA Engage. Each chapter may determine the approach that best fits its needs, while considering member privacy, ease of maintenance, and the desired level of visibility for chapter leaders.

Options for displaying chapter leadership information include:

- Manually maintain leadership information by entering and updating board and committee leader details as changes occur. This option provides the greatest flexibility and control over content, format, and display. Example: Milwaukee Chapter.
- Display limited information and provide a general chapter contact method rather than listing individual leaders. This approach may be preferred by chapters seeking to minimize maintenance requirements or limit the public display of personal information.
  Example: San Francisco Chapter.
- Publish a static board or leadership image that includes names, titles, and photographs. While this approach allows greater control over presentation, updates must be made manually and leader profiles will not be linked. Example: Sydney Chapter.
- Use the Engage leadership widget to dynamically display chapter leaders based on information maintained in ISACA's chapter leadership records. This option reduces manual maintenance because updates are reflected when ISACA Global updates the chapter's official leader roster. However:
  - The display order cannot be customized.
  - Individuals must upload their own photo to their Engage profile if they wish their photo to appear.
  - Individuals must set their profile visibility to *Public* for profile information and photos to be displayed. Example: Malta Chapter.

Chapter leaders should periodically review their chapter's public website content to ensure information is accurate, current, and consistent with chapter preferences, privacy considerations, and ISACA requirements.

Need help with your chapter's Engage site? Send an email to chaptersiteadmins@isaca.org.

Mentoring

The Chapter President and Vice President should actively support the development, engagement, and success of chapter volunteers. Providing guidance, coaching, and leadership development opportunities helps strengthen volunteer effectiveness, build future leaders, and support the long-term sustainability of the chapter.

The Chapter President should:

- Encourage and support the professional growth and development of chapter volunteers, committee members, and emerging leaders.
- Work with the Vice President, board members, and committee chairs to provide orientation, mentoring, coaching, and ongoing support to volunteers, as appropriate.
- Monitor volunteer engagement and performance and provide constructive feedback when expectations, responsibilities, or commitments are not being met.
- Address performance concerns in a timely and professional manner through coaching, mentoring, role clarification, or other appropriate support measures.
- Collaborate with board members and committee leaders to identify and develop future chapter leaders and promote leadership succession planning.
- Foster a positive volunteer experience that encourages continued engagement, leadership development, and knowledge transfer.

Succession Planning

Chapters are encouraged to establish leadership development and succession planning practices that help ensure continuity of operations and governance. One approach is to create a **President-Elect**, **Deputy Director**, or similar leadership development position that allows an emerging leader to gain experience and prepare for future service as Chapter President.

Such positions can provide:

- A structured transition and leadership development period for future chapter leaders.
- Opportunities for mentoring and knowledge transfer from current leaders.
- Greater leadership continuity and organizational resilience.
- Enhanced volunteer engagement and leadership pipeline development.

If a chapter chooses to establish a President-Elect, Deputy Director, or similar position, the role, responsibilities, authority, and succession provisions should be clearly defined in the chapter's bylaws.

Turnover Procedures

Leadership Transition and Handover
A well-planned leadership transition helps maintain operational continuity, preserve institutional knowledge, and position the chapter for future success. The outgoing Chapter President should work closely with incoming leaders, officers, directors, committee chairs, and volunteers to ensure a timely and effective transfer of responsibilities.

As part of the leadership transition process, the outgoing Chapter President should:

- Ensure the timely transfer of relevant chapter records, files, correspondence, credentials, and institutional knowledge to incoming officers, directors, committee chairs, and other authorized leaders.
- Confirm that all required annual reporting and compliance obligations have been completed or appropriately assigned, including any reports due to ISACA Global.
- Establish a transition timeline and target completion date for all turnover activities.
- Coordinate with chapter officers, directors, and committee chairs to review and update chapter procedures, forms, operational documentation, and governance records, as appropriate.
- Prepare, or coordinate the preparation of, a list of open items and ongoing activities requiring follow-up by incoming leaders. Examples may include:
    - Outstanding invoices awaiting payment approval or processing.
    - Venue, facility, or service contracts for upcoming chapter events.
    - Speaker, instructor, sponsor, or vendor agreements for future programs.
    - Strategic initiatives, projects, or operational matters that remain incomplete.
    - Other commitments, obligations, or action items requiring continued attention.
- Facilitate transition meetings between outgoing and incoming leaders to support knowledge transfer, answer questions, and promote continuity. These meetings may be conducted individually or as a group, depending on the chapter's needs.
- Work with the Treasurer to review and update the chapter's inventory of assets, equipment, records, and other chapter property.
- Ensure that all chapter-owned property, records, and resources are appropriately transferred to authorized incoming leaders.
- Confirm that banking, financial, and other administrative accounts are updated as necessary to reflect leadership changes, including authorized signatories. Chapters are encouraged to maintain multiple authorized signers and appropriate internal controls in accordance with board-approved policies.
- Ensure access to chapter mailboxes, post office boxes, technology platforms, websites, social media accounts, cloud storage, email systems, and other chapter resources is transferred to authorized incoming leaders and removed for outgoing leaders, as appropriate.
- Transfer current correspondence files and other important records to the incoming Chapter President, including materials, resources, and guidance

provided by ISACA Global that may support future chapter operations.

Recognition and Appreciation

The outgoing Chapter President should also consider coordinating a volunteer Recognition activity or event to acknowledge and celebrate the contributions of board members, committee leaders, volunteers, and members whose efforts supported the chapter's success throughout the year.

Appendix

Timetable for Action

President's Annual Checklist

- Ensure all chapter events are included on the Engage chapter website.
- Between 1 November – 31 December each year,
  - Submit the online compliance checklist.
  - Submit the audit or financial verification letter to ISACA Global.
  - Submit any other mandatory items to ISACA Global as needed.
  - Conduct an orientation for all incoming chapter leaders. Include:
    - Mission and vision statements
    - Organizational history
    - Bylaws and policies
    - Strategic plan
    - Financial summaries
    - Committee information
    - Meeting processes
    - Chapter Affiliation Agreement
  - Submit the list of volunteers appointed and elected at the AGM to the Chapter Experience team via ISACA Support.

    - Develop chapter goals and strategies for the new year via a strategic planning session.
    - Ensure all volunteers have signed and submitted to the chapter's secretary the Conflict of Interest Statement and the Willingness to Serve Agreement.
- Within **60 days** of the AGM:
    - Ensure the chapter's goals and strategic plans are in progress.
- Within **210 days (approximately 7 months)** of the AGM:
    - Begin recruiting volunteers for the following year/term.

Key Links

- Chapter Leader Portal
- Policies
- Chapter Bylaws Template
- Membership
- Credentialing (certifications and certificates)
- Training and Events
- ISACA Newsroom
- COBIT
- One In Tech
- SheLeadsTech